CHAPTER 1

An App to Get You Started

Welcome! PostgreSQL and Rails are mature, powerful, and modern technologies. If you're here to level up your skills using these technologies together, you've picked up the right book.

The best way to learn is from hands on practice and experimentation. Here you'll work on exercises using practical examples, with a Rails API app connected to PostgreSQL. You may want to challenge yourself on topics you're familiar with to build your own examples. Growth happens when solving challenges just beyond your current skill level.

In this chapter, you'll primarily get things installed and set up. You may have a lot of experience with Ruby on Rails and less or none at all with PostgreSQL. On the PostgreSQL side, you may be an experienced administrator but know little about Ruby on Rails, or perhaps use another popular web framework. Here you'll get information wherever you fall in those skill areas.

The Ruby on Rails app you'll use here is called *Rideshare*, and it's proudly configured to work with PostgreSQL. This is a open source Rails application that's available to download from GitHub.

Rideshare serves as a demonstration application both for Rails and Active Record concepts, and for PostgreSQL concepts. When the topic involves working directly with PostgreSQL, you'll use the Rideshare database. When the topic is a Rails topic, you'll work with the Rideshare Ruby codebase.

What's the Rideshare app all about?

What Is Rideshare?

Rideshare is an API-only web application that implements a portion of a fictional ridesharing service. Think of Uber or Lyft. Imagine there could be mil-